Characteristics of Living Organisms

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

Download PDF

Written by: Lára Marie McIvor
Reviewed by: Lucy Kirkham
Updated on 30 October 2024

SaveMyExams

Did this video help you? Yes No

Characteristics of Living Organisms

- **Movement**: an action by an organism or part of an organism causing a change of position or place
- **Respiration**: the chemical reactions that break down nutrient molecules in living cells to release energy for metabolism
- **Sensitivity**: the ability to detect or sense stimuli in the internal or external environment and to make appropriate responses
- **Growth**: a permanent increase in size and dry mass by an increase in cell number or cell size or both
- **Reproduction**: the processes that make more of the same kind of organism
- **Excretion**: the removal from organisms of toxic materials, the waste products of metabolism (chemical reactions in cells including respiration) and substances in excess of requirements
- **Nutrition**: the taking in of materials for energy, growth and development; plants require light, carbon dioxide, water and ions; animals need organic compounds, ions and usually need water

Help me understand

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

Use this mnemonic to help you remember these processes:

MRS. GREN

- **M**ovement
- **R**espiration
- **S**ensitivity
- **G**rowth and development
- **R**eproduction
- **E**xcretion
- **N**utrition

Teacher only

New! Exclusive Teacher-Only Questions

- Fresh, expert-written questions
- Students can't access them
- Fair accurate tests - built fast

Explore in Test Builder

Test yourself Flashcards

Was this revision note helpful? Yes No

Next

Course Study tools All topics

Resources

Learning Hub
Scholarship
Join
Past Papers
Solution Banks

Dashboard

Overview
Brand ambassador
Profile
Subscription
Settings

About us
Exam Specificity
Content Quality
Promotions
Jobs
Terms
Privacy
Cookie Policy
Help and Support

Biology
Chemistry
Physics
Maths
Geography
English Literature
Psychology
All Subjects

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.
Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.